

Q. How do you perceive India's diplomacy with the new government in Bangladesh?

Sensible and tactical

21

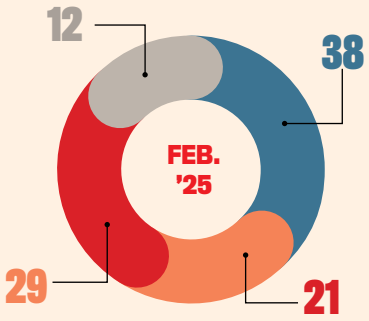
Did not react strongly enough to killing of Hindus in Bangladesh

32

Must not interfere in internal affairs of Bangladesh

29

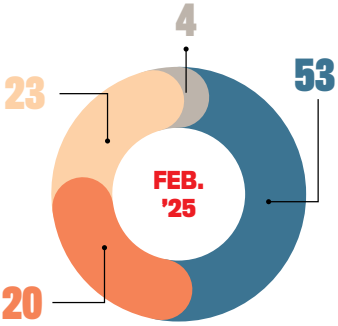
Q. What's your opinion on the Indian government sheltering former Bangladesh prime minister Sheikh Hasina?



She was an ally of India, so it's the right thing to do
She should be sent back to Bangladesh to improve India's ties with the current dispensation
She should not be sent back but should be asked to go to another country
DK/ CS

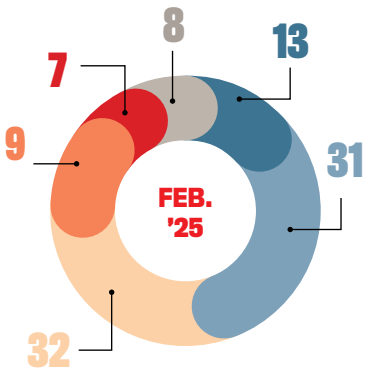
Rest DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say; All figures in % and rounded off

Q. What should be India's priority in managing its relationship with China?



Strengthening border security
Enhancing trade relationships
Pursuing diplomatic dialogues
DK/ CS

Q. How do you think US president Donald Trump will be for India?



Very good
Good
No impact
Bad
Disastrous
DK/ CS

Not many have total confidence in India's prosperity during the Trump presidency; two-thirds are cautiously optimistic, and say it won't matter

45%

feel India should have peace talks with Pakistan; 39 per cent disagree; 14 per cent are for cultural exchanges only

73%

think India's foreign policy under Modi has strengthened its global standing; a quarter disagrees

ing an astute balance in ties with its old ally Russia, and that with the West and the US. This was taken note of by 72.6 per cent of respondents, who think India's foreign policy under PM Modi has increased the country's global stature. However, 24 per cent disagree.

On peace talks with Pakistan, India swears by its principled stand: talks and Pakistan-sponsored terrorism on its soil cannot co-exist. On whether India should talk with Pakistan even as it pushes terrorism, a surprising 44.7 per cent say yes, while 38.5 per cent reject the idea. Interestingly, 13.8 per cent of MOTN respondents are against talks, but are open to the two nations having cultural exchanges, including hosting each other's cricket teams.

India shares good relations with its other neighbours—Nepal, Myanmar, Sri Lanka and Maldives—though there have been occasional difficulties. However, only 39.2 per cent say ties with neighbours have improved, compared to 60.9 per cent in August 2024. Ties have deteriorated or are worrisome, say 32.6 per cent of respondents, compared to 21 per cent in August 2024. ■